

owners were called capitalists, and the new system, capitalism. The new manufacturing industry, and the capitalist system it brought with it, spread from Britain across Europe and America. Because mechanization meant that goods could be produced more cheaply and in greater quantities, it brought prosperity for the capitalist class. Since the Industrial Revolution, industries have kept improving their efficiency, which has made societies wealthier. It wasn't only manufacturing industries that benefitted. Agriculture, mining, and construction have also become increasingly mechanized, reducing costs and increasing production. Alongside these industries there was a need for services, such as construction and repairs, to keep them running smoothly, and financial services, such as banking and insurance. As societies grew richer, more people had money to spend on goods that had been seen as luxuries, or services that they used to do for themselves.